

MScFE POLICY

Master of Science in Financial Engineering

Academic Year 2026/2027

OFFICIAL POLICY — ACADEMIC YEAR 2026/2027

Editorial line: present the MScFE, its disciplines, its competencies, its academic framework and its professional applications. Institutional references are deliberately secondary and factual.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY OF THE IDLA - WQU - WQF SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAM

1. GENERAL PRESENTATION OF THE MScFE

The Master of Science in Financial Engineering (MScFE) is an advanced financial engineering program designed to develop quantitative, mathematical, statistical, computer science and financial skills applied to modern finance issues.

Financial engineering lies at the intersection of several disciplines: Finance + Mathematics + Statistics + Computer Science + Data Science + Artificial Intelligence.

The objective is to train professionals capable of analyzing financial data, building and interpreting models, valuing instruments and strategies, studying risks and using computational tools to address complex financial problems.

The program is part of the evolution toward finance increasingly based on data, quantitative modeling, automation and computational technologies.

2. POSITIONING: FINANCE, QUANT, DATA AND AI

The MScFE brings together four major areas of competency: finance, quantitative methods, programming and data analysis.

This combination makes it possible to approach finance from an analytical and computational perspective: understanding markets, structuring data, modeling uncertainty, valuing instruments, analyzing risks, optimizing portfolios and interpreting model results.

The quantitative dimension — “Quant” — is therefore a central pillar of the program. It does not refer only to a profession, but to a way of approaching financial problems through mathematics, statistics, programming and data.

3. MAIN AREAS OF STUDY

The program covers financial markets, financial data, statistical and econometric methods, derivatives pricing, stochastic modeling, machine learning, deep learning, portfolio management, risk management and a capstone project.

The official academic structure comprises nine graduate-level courses and a Capstone, with a sequential progression. The official program also indicates a duration of two years and a workload commitment of approximately 20 to 25 hours per week for admitted students.

4. CORRESPONDENCE BETWEEN PREVIOUS EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUNDS AND THE MScFE

The MScFE is interdisciplinary. Certain academic backgrounds offer a particularly natural continuity with the quantitative and computational methods used in the program.

Formation initiale	**Correspondance avec le MScFE**
Mathématiques / Mathématiques appliquées	Probability, statistics, optimization, quantitative modeling
Statistiques	Econometrics, data analysis, risk modeling
Informatique / Computer Science	Programming, algorithms, data science, machine learning
Ingénierie	Modeling, optimization, scientific computing, programming
Physique	Mathematical modeling, probability, complex systems
Économie / Économie quantitative	Econometrics, time series, market analysis
Finance	Markets, portfolio, pricing, risk
Data Science	Financial data, statistics, predictive models
Disciplines quantitatives connexes	To be assessed according to the official admission prerequisites

5. EXAMPLES OF DISCIPLINARY CORRELATIONS

- AI applied to finance: Artificial Intelligence → Machine Learning → Deep Learning → financial data → quantitative models and decisions.
- Mathematics applied to finance: Probability → stochastic calculus → pricing → risk → optimization.
- Computer science applied to finance: Python → data processing → algorithms → machine learning → computational finance.
- Economics applied to quantitative finance: econometrics → time series → financial data → modeling.
- Finance applied to quantitative management: markets → portfolio → risk → optimization → quantitative analysis.

6. SKILLS DEVELOPED

The program aims in particular to develop skills in the following areas:

- mathematical and probabilistic skills;
- statistics and econometrics;
- programmation et outils computationnels ;
- processing, structuring and analysis of financial data;
- quantitative modeling;
- pricing et hedging ;

- risk management and modeling;
- optimisation et gestion de portefeuille ;
- applied machine learning and deep learning;
- communication of technical and professional results;
- critical thinking and problem-solving.

7. ACADEMIC ELIGIBILITY

The admission reference to be retained is that of the official program criteria. The minimum academic level indicated is a Bachelor's Degree or an equivalent university degree recognized within the admission process.

Applicants with backgrounds in mathematics, applied mathematics, statistics, information technology, computer science, engineering, physics, economics, finance, quantitative economics, data science and related quantitative disciplines may have particularly strong alignment with the MScFE.

Admission remains subject to the official criteria and procedures in force, including documentary requirements, quantitative level, English proficiency where required, and other published conditions.

8. ACCREDITATION AND ACADEMIC FRAMEWORK

The program is offered within the framework of the partnership between INTERNATIONAL DISTANCE LEARNING ACADEMY - WQU and the WorldQuant Foundation.

Program accredited by the Distance Education Accrediting Commission (DEAC). The DEAC is recognized by the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA) and by the U.S. Department of Education (USDE).

The DEAC is an institutional accrediting organization recognized by the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA) and by the U.S. Department of Education (USDE). Its recognized scope includes higher education institutions primarily offering distance education programs and awarding credentials up to the master's level.

Accreditation is an element of the institutional framework for quality and academic accountability. By itself, it does not constitute a guarantee of identical regulatory recognition in all countries; national rules, professional bodies and employers may apply their own criteria.

9. ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL VALUE

The MScFE aims to develop transferable skills applicable to several sectors that make extensive use of data, modeling and quantitative analysis.

Possible areas of application include:

- finance quantitative ;
- financial analysis and computational finance;
- gestion des risques ;
- gestion de portefeuille et asset management ;
- financial modeling ;
- data science applied to finance;
- fintech ;
- banque et services financiers ;

- assurance ;
- recherche et analytics ;
- quantitative functions in highly data-driven organizations.

The degree does not constitute an automatic guarantee of employment, remuneration or access to a particular financial market.

10. MScFE AND GLOBAL FINANCE

Financial engineering skills can be applied within major international financial ecosystems.

Wall Street in New York and the City of London in London are two major reference points in global finance. Other important financial centers include Singapore, Hong Kong, Dubai, Frankfurt, Paris, Zurich and Toronto.

The international positioning of the MScFE should be understood as an opening toward skills and professions whose applications may extend beyond a single country. Actual access to employment or a regulated profession nevertheless depends on the relevant market, local law, required qualifications and each candidate's profile.

11. MODE OF DELIVERY

The program is offered by IDLA within its official academic framework. It is based on structured progression, applied activities, coursework, and the development of quantitative and computational skills.

Personal availability, access to a suitable computer, connectivity and the required study time are practical elements that the candidate should anticipate.

13. COVERAGE POLICY

Under this policy, the financial coverage applicable to the program is structured as follows.

Élément	**Statut**	**Précision**
Academic tuition fees	**100 % couverts**	0 FCFA in tuition fees under the announced coverage
Enrollment fees	**COUVERTS**	0 FCFA payable as separate enrollment fees
Administrative fees applicable to the program	**COVERED BY THE STUDENT **	450,000 FCFA / academic year
Infrastructure	**Aucun frais spécifique prévu**	
Laboratory / equipment	**Aucun frais spécifique prévu**	
Internet / connectivity	**Aucun frais spécifique prévu**	
Materials / resources	**Aucun frais spécifique prévu**	

14. ADMINISTRATIVE FEES AND DOCUMENTATION

The administrative fees applicable to the program are set at 450,000 FCFA per academic year.

These fees are separate from the coverage of tuition fees and enrollment fees.

15. STUDENT RESPONSIBILITIES

The student remains responsible for complying with academic criteria, admission procedures and deadlines, submitting the required documents, and maintaining their commitment to the program.

Financial coverage does not constitute a guarantee of admission, academic success, degree completion or employment.

16. RECOMMENDED INSTITUTIONAL WORDING

“The MScFE is a master’s-level program in financial engineering that combines finance, mathematics, statistics, programming, data science and artificial intelligence in order to develop quantitative skills applied to modern finance issues.

The program is delivered within an American academic framework accredited by the DEAC, an organization recognized by CHEA and the U.S. Department of Education. Admission conditions, accreditation status and coverage arrangements must always be interpreted according to official documents and applicable rules.

Under this policy, tuition fees and enrollment fees are covered according to the conditions of the scholarship; an amount of 450,000 FCFA per academic year is provided for administrative and documentation fees.”

17. FINAL PROVISIONS

This policy defines the framework for presenting the MScFE, the general eligibility conditions, the academic framework and the financial coverage applicable to the program for the 2026/2027 academic year.

All communication relating to the program must remain consistent with the official admission conditions, the institutional documents in force and the applicable rules.